



April 25th 2017 Delaware County Council Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=1-p_6x_A9pk
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Delaware County Council Meeting Report

Meeting Date: April 25, 2017

1. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer called the Delaware County Council meeting to order on April 25, 2017.
- **Attendance:**
 - *Members Present:* Council members explicitly noted or participating in roll calls include Bledsoe, Chambers, Lassiter, Mattox, Piper, and Scott.
 - *Presiding Officer:* Council President (name not explicitly stated in opening remarks).

2. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The meeting opened with the Pledge of Allegiance led by the presiding officer.
- **Approval of Minutes:**
 - Motion to approve the minutes of March 28th.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed 7-0 by roll call vote.

3. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:01:54 Financial Agenda: Assessor Photography & Blueprints**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Assessor Carmel Carmichael / Finance.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation of \$10,000 in Fund 316 (surveyors photography and blueprints).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- **00:02:41 Sheriff Misdemeanor Fund: Equipment / Vehicle Request**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Delaware County Sheriff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for \$100,000 from Fund 441 (equipment) for a new prisoner transport van (Transit van model to improve fuel economy), plus funding supporting a small transport vehicle and the jail commander's vehicle (replacing a pursuit-rated Tahoe).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- **00:07:18 Sheriff's Fleet & Vehicle Inventory Presentation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Delaware County Sheriff.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The Sheriff presented a comprehensive department fleet inventory highlighting that 27 older vehicles were traded in over a two-year period for 6 new vehicles (reducing the total fleet by 21 vehicles). Discussion covered moving to SUV/Tahoe models for county terrain and weather capabilities, undercover lease vehicles, and specialty equipment/trailers.
- **00:17:18 Assessor Disclosure & Equipment Appropriations**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carmel Carmichael, County Assessor.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Appropriation requests under Fund 316: \$5,000 for aerial photography and \$1,500 for software/hardware monitors to replace office computer monitors.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote.
- **00:18:47 Highway Department Appropriations & Health Insurance Withdrawal**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Highway Department / Council President.
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - The highway health insurance request was withdrawn because it was incorrectly advertised under the highway fund rather than the proper fringe/health fund; it will be re-advertised for next month.
 - Miscellaneous equipment request for Highway (Fund 460) for \$7,100 to purchase a crack-sealing/pothole patching unit ("drip catcher") designed to provide permanent pavement patching and extend road life compared to temporary cold/hot patch.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Crack-sealing equipment appropriation approved by roll call vote.
- **00:22:26 County Commissioner Annual Capital Improvement Plan Appropriation**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Commissioners / Commissioners' Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Annual appropriation for the County Commissioner capital plan totaling \$2 million (including Downtown Development projects such as Project

51 and Project 59 on the northwest and southeast corners, and a newly added Project 61 for county improvement/community-based organizations addressing drug and psychological addictions).

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote [00:26:04](#).
- **00:26:25 Superior Court 1: Part-Time Staff Salary Adjustment**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Superior Court 1.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Request for part-time transcript clerk salary adjustment (\$500 base plus \$500 approval).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote [00:26:46](#).
- **00:27:01 EMS Salary Adjustments**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** EMS Department / Council.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Adjustments for paramedic positions (\$25,592 each) under prior hiring/salary ordinance rules ("rubber-stamp rule" pending transition to consolidated new ordinance).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote [00:27:55](#).
- **00:28:06 Jail: Correctional Officer Salary Adjustments**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jail Department.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Adjustments for correctional officer positions (\$25,637.45) under old ordinance structure.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote [00:28:30](#).
- **00:28:40 Auditor's Office: Salary and Wages**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Auditor's Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Adjustment for entry clerk master position (\$17,523.69) under the new hiring and salary ordinance.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote [00:31:07](#).
- **00:32:04 Community Corrections Salary & Administrative Adjustments**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Community Corrections.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Adjustments for case manager (\$15,397.90), administrative assistant, part-time funds (\$12,400), and administrative secretary (\$1,500 health insurance plus \$5,317.26; total salary breakdown clarified as \$31,500).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote [00:33:06](#).
- **00:33:15 Highway Department Salary Adjustments & Bookkeeper Transfer**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Highway Department / Finance.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Adjustments for equipment operators, truck drivers, overtime, and transferring a bookkeeper position from the county budget to the highway budget to cover longevity and salary.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by voice vote / roll call.
- **00:33:19 Public Defender Salary Adjustments**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Public Defender Office.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Disability insurance (+ \$132) and witness fees (- \$132) transfer.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote [00:33:39](#).
- [00:34:03](#) **Communication Center (911) Salary Line Transfers**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** 911 Director / Finance / HR.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Salary line adjustments (\$24,005) under the new salary ordinance, coordinating with HR and the Auditor to streamline advertising and hiring for vacancies.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote [00:36:33](#).
- [00:37:19](#) **Financial Transfers & Salary Ordinance Omnibus Approval**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Motion to approve all financial transfers with respective reductions and to amend the salary ordinance accordingly.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by roll call vote [00:37:41](#).
- [00:38:35](#) **Second Reading: Ordinance 17-08 (Sheriff Interdiction Revenue Appropriation)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Delaware County Sheriff / Council.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Second and final reading of Ordinance 17-08 regarding appropriations from the Delaware County Sheriff interdiction revenue fund.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Passed 7-0 by roll call vote [00:39:11](#).
- [00:39:42](#) **Discussion & Resolution Regarding State Legislation on Needle Exchange Programs (HB 1438)**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** County Sheriff & EMS Nursing Educator Director.
 - **Deliberation Summary:**
 - The Sheriff and EMS representatives spoke against House Bill 1438 (recently passed by the General Assembly and sent to the Governor), which allows local legislative/executive bodies to authorize syringe/needle exchange programs.
 - Presenters argued that needle exchange programs ("needle giveaways") increase drug usage frequency, fuel property crime to obtain drug money, and worsen overdose risks (citing high daily overdose statistics and local paraphernalia examples including cookers, cotton balls, ties, and condoms).
 - The Council discussed adopting an official stance or joint resolution opposing the implementation of a needle exchange program in Delaware County.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion approved to instruct the Council attorney to work with the prosecutor and commissioners' attorney to prepare a formal document/resolution opposing needle exchange programs in Delaware County. Passed by roll call vote [00:48:47](#).
- [00:55:00](#) **Sheriff<U+2019>s Department DROP (Deferred Retirement Option Plan) Pension Discussion**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council Attorney / Council Members / Sheriff's Representatives.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Extensive discussion concerning the mechanics, contractual standing, actuarial review, and financial impact of the Sheriff<U+2019>s

Department DROP program amendment. Council members raised questions regarding whether the plan requires Commissioner approval, how future promotions and cost neutrality work when senior officers enter the DROP program, and interest rates credited to escrow accounts.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Tabled / deferred for further review, actuarial clarification, and placement on next month's agenda.

4. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(General floor comments from residents or officials near the conclusion of the meeting) -

00:55:00 County Attorney & Council Members: Addressed procedural questions regarding the Sheriff's pension DROP program, contract approvals, and actuarial reviews.

5. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Reminder for council members to sign their certifications of nepotism and file them with the Commissioners' office.
 - Matters regarding the DROP pension program and the highway health insurance advertising will return at the next regular meeting.
- **Adjournment:** The meeting concluded following final remarks regarding paperwork and upcoming agenda scheduling.

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